

with Microsoft wowing the crowds during its demonstration of Windows Mobile 6.5, there are quite a few of us who would love to be running the OS on a full-fledged smart phone like the N97.

Our wish is HTC's command, it seems, as it offers up a sequel to its popular Touch Pro slide-out Qwerty handset. Running on Windows Mobile 6.1, the Touch Pro 2 can be upgraded to 6.5 when it releases. With the addition of Pocket Office, the device is a complete package for those who work hard and party harder.

Of course, that is not the only change. The Touch Pro 2 does everything bigger and better than its predecessor, starting with the resistive touchscreen TFT. The 3.6-inch display renders 65K colours at 480x800 pixels with ease. The TouchFlo 3D interface is going to be an absolute treat on this knock-out, which packs an accelerometer, handwriting recognition and a touch-sensitive zoom bar.

The phone is powered by a Qualcomm MSM7200A 528 MHz processor, 288MB RAM and 512MB of ROM (expandable via microSD).

Surprisingly, HTC has decided to forgo an LED flash on the video-enabled 3-megapixel camera. The autofocus persists, but your 2048x1536 pixel images might just be too darn grainy at night.

The 3G compatibility will come in handy when making video calls on the secondary VGA camera. Also starring in this epic are Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, stereo FM, TV-out and a special guest appearance by GPS.

Offering seven hours of continuous talk-time, June will throw out the red carpet for this superstar.

4.5 – Sony Ericsson IDOU

Shutterbugs, kneel! The king is here!

Just when you thought mobile phone cameras had reached a saturation point, Lennard Hoornik – Sony Ericsson Head of Global Marketing and Vice President – jumped up on stage at the Mobile World Congress in February and showed off the Idou's 12-megapixel camera. Twelve! Most of us use digital cameras that max out at 8-megapixels!

Of course, when you are throwing in so much effort into it,